Drawing the Lines

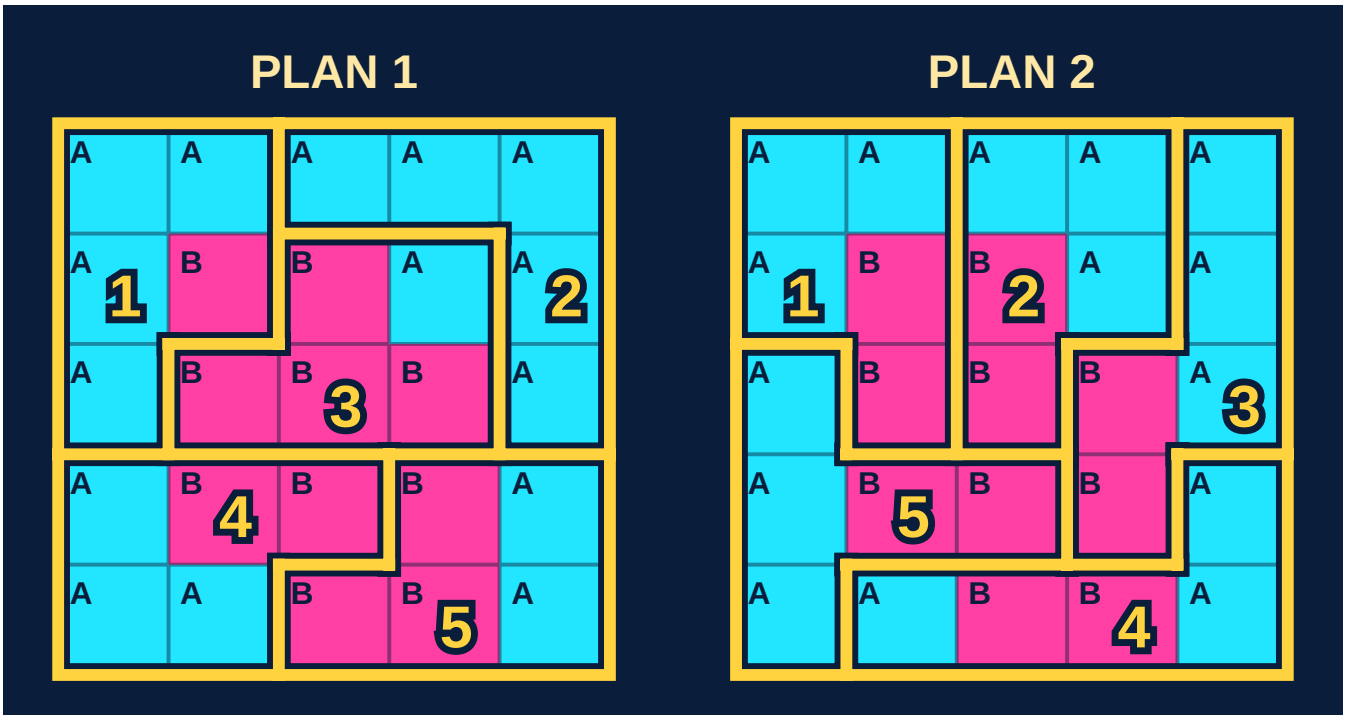
AP Human Geography · Unit 4 · Two stimuli (like Question 3) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

Directions: Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

Westmoor, a fictional U.S. state, has 25 voting precincts with equal populations and 5 seats in the U.S. House of Representatives. After the census, mapmakers proposed two plans for grouping those precincts into 5 districts, using the same voters and votes.

Stimulus 1: Two District Plans for Westmoor



A = precinct won by Party A B = precinct won by Party B District border 1–5 = district number

Fictional state created for practice. Simplified: all 25 precincts have equal populations, and a party wins a district by winning at least 3 of its 5 precincts.

Stimulus 2: Election Results in Westmoor Under Each Plan

Result	Party A	Party B
Statewide vote share	60%	40%
Precincts won (of 25)	15	10
Districts won under Plan 1 (of 5)	3	2
Percent of seats under Plan 1	60%	40%
Districts won under Plan 2 (of 5)	5	0
Percent of seats under Plan 2	100%	0%

Fictional data created for practice, with the same statewide vote under both plans. Remember: label each part, and write Describe and Explain parts as T1- (your reason in general words), E2- (the specific proof), A3- (why it matters).

A. **Using Stimulus 1, identify the gerrymandering technique used to draw the district boundaries in Plan 2.** IDENTIFY

B. **Using Stimulus 1, describe how the district boundaries in Plan 2 divide Party B's voters.** DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

C. **Explain why the boundaries of congressional districts in the United States are redrawn every ten years.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

D. **Using both stimuli, explain how Plan 2 produces an election result that does not match the statewide vote.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

E. **Using Stimulus 2, explain ONE effect that a districting plan like Plan 2 could have on voters or on political representation.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

F. **Explain ONE way that an independent redistricting commission OR a compactness requirement could reduce gerrymandering like the one in Plan 2.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

G. **Explain how district boundaries like those in Plan 2 could act as a centrifugal force in a country.** EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-